

8 Essential Question Words

Arabic	Pronounce	Meaning	Example
من	man	who (people)	من أنت؟ — Who are you?
ما	maa	what (things)	ما هذا؟ — What is this?
ماذا	maadhaa	what (actions)	ماذا تفعل؟ — What are you doing?
أين	ayna	where	أين البيت؟ — Where is the house?
متى	mataa	when	متى الدرس؟ — When is the lesson?
كيف	kayfa	how	كيف حالك؟ — How are you?
كم	kam	how many	كم كتاباً؟ — How many books?
لماذا	limaadha	why	لماذا؟ — Why?

RULE: من = who (people only). ما = what (things only). Never mix them.

Common Exchanges

Question	Answer
ما هذا؟	هذا كتاب — This is a book
من هذا؟	هذا مدرس — This is a teacher
كيف حالك؟	بخير الحمد لله — Fine, praise Allah

من من يعمل خيراً = Whoever does good: appears 300+ times in Quran

□ The greeting exchange كيف حالك / بخير الحمد لله is a complete Islamic dialogue